

Sacramental Dates in our Parish Schools

St Malachy's PS, Kilclief

First Confession on Tuesday 2nd March time to be confirmed

First Holy Communion on Saturday 8th May at 10.30am

Confirmation on Thursday 27th May at 11am

St Joseph's PS, Strangford

First Confession on Tuesday 9th March at 7pm

First Holy Communion on Saturday 22nd May at 11am

Confirmation on Thursday 27th May at 11am

St Patrick's PS, Saul

First Confession on Wednesday 10th March time to be confirmed

First Holy Communion on Saturday 15th May at 11am

Confirmation on Friday 26th February at 11am



WOMEN'S DISCERNMENT NIGHT

Are you a young woman discerning God's call? Join us for an evening of prayer, reflection, and fellowship with the Nashville Dominican Sisters as we explore God's call in our lives. Whether you're just beginning to ask the question or have been discerning for some time, all women throughout the Diocese aged 18-40 are welcome. Stay afterwards for refreshments and the chance to continue the conversation in a relaxed and friendly atmosphere. Our guest speaker is Sr Mary Sheila Maksim OP, Vocations Director for the Diocese of Limerick.

THURSDAY 22ND OCTOBER 7PM

ST COLMCILLE'S CHURCH, BALLYHACKAMORE

RSVP TO DAVID: D.GOODWIN@DOWNANDCONNOR.ORG



DIocese OF
DOWN & CONNOR

SAFEGUARDING - If you have a concern, suspicion, or wish to make an allegation of child abuse, or abuse in relation to an adult at risk, please contact the Diocesan Safeguarding Office: Philip O'Hara, Designated Liaison Person, 120, Cliftonville Road, Belfast BT14 6LA. Mobile: 07534 992124 or Telephone: 028 90 492798. Email: philip.ohara@soddc.org or visit <https://downandconnorsafeguarding.com>

Very Rev Fr Aidan Brankin, Parish Priest 02844 612525 (Saul) or 02844 260101 (Strangford)

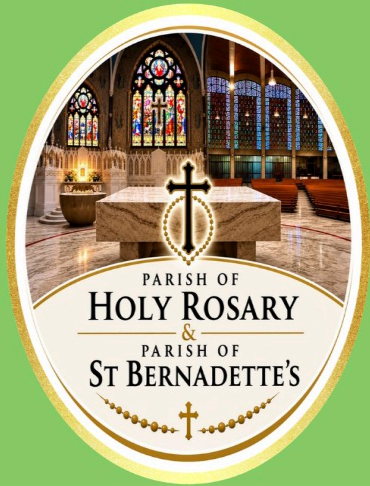
Saul Office: 02844 612525, Office Hours: Mon to Fri 9.30am to 12noon 10 St Patrick's Rd, Downpatrick, BT30 7JG

Kilclief Office: 02844260101 Office Hours: Monday 1pm to 3pm 8 Shore Rd, Strangford, BT30 7NL

Website: www.saulandballeeparish.com

Email: saul@downandconnor.org strangfordandkilclief@downandconnor.org

MASS SCHEDULE SUNDAYS



ST BERNADETTE'S PARISH
Vigil 6.00pm & 11am
HOLY ROSARY PARISH
9am, 10.30am & 12.30pm

WEEKDAYS
St Bernadette's Parish:
Mon, Tues & Wed 9.30am
Holy Rosary Parish:
Thurs, Fri & Sat 10.00am

SACRAMENT OF RECONCILIATION
Good Shepherd church Saturday **10.30am**
St. Bernadette's church Saturday **5.15pm**

BAPTISMS
(Prior booking via Parish Office)
Due to the number of families requesting Baptisms we have added extra Baptism dates to our parish calendar!

Good Shepherd Church:
At 2p.m on the 1st and 3rd Sunday of the month.

St Bernadette's Church:
At 2p.m on the 1st Saturday of the month.

CONTACT INFORMATION

Fr. Brendan Hickland (028) 90642446 (Option 1)
b.hickland@downandconnor.org

Fr. Babu Panattuparambil Vareed (028) 9079 3023.
b.panattuparambil@downandconnor.org

Fr. Eddie O' Donnell (028) 90642446
e.odonnell@downandconnor.org

Rev. Patrick Keown (Deacon) p.keown@downandconnor.org

Kylee (Parish Support Officer) Office Hours
Mon-Thurs 9.15a.m - 1p.m. Closed Fridays

Holy Rosary Parish Office (028) 90642446 Option 2
holyrosary@downandconnor.org

Philomena (Finance Officer) p.dawson@downandconnor.org

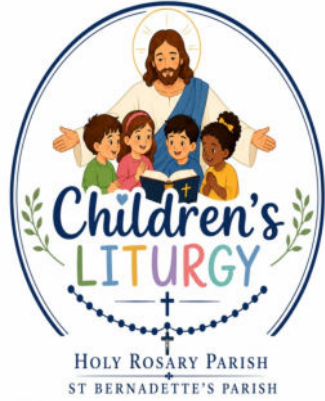
More Information and resources:
holyrosaryparishbelfast.net and www.st.bernadettesparish.org

SPRED

Would you like to develop your faith in a different direction?
Do you - or someone you know - have an intellectual disability?
SPRED is a unique community within our diocese and beyond made up of adults with intellectual disabilities and volunteers. It aims to enrich the spiritual life of all members of it's community through prayer and friendship. Our local group is very low in numbers and needs new members. If you or someone you know would like to know more please contact
Paul: 07817193044



TWENTY-SIXTH SUNDAY IN ORDINARY TIME
SUNDAY
27th September
Readings: A (I) ♦ Psalter: Week 2



St. Bernadette's Children's Liturgy

Children's Liturgy will resume at the **11:00am Mass** and will continue every fortnight on the dates listed below. All children of Primary School age are welcome. All new children must complete the Parents Consent forms which can be completed online by scanning our QR code or a paper copy which are available on our notice board at the back of the church. Looking forward to another fun year together. Any adults wishing to become a member of the children Liturgy please contact:
Mary Grace Wilson on 07554386905.

Dates for Children's Liturgy

<u>Holy Rosary</u>	4th/18th October	1st/15th/29th November	13th December	
<u>St Bernadette's</u>	27th September	11th/25th October	8th /22nd November	6th /20th December



? LIFE AFTER ALPHA ? INVITATION TO CONTINUE THE JOURNEY ChristLife 'FOLLOWING CHRIST' Course

When Jesus called his first Disciples he said, "Come Follow Me." He still makes that call to us today. The 'ChristLife' series is an opportunity for you to respond to that call and continue that journey you embarked upon with Alpha. **FOLLOWING CHRIST** is a 7-week course with a one day Retreat to help you grow as a disciple of Jesus. The next session is **TUESDAY 29th SEPTEMBER 2026** at 7:00pm in **HOLY ROSARY PARISH CENTRE, 503 Ormeau Road, BT7 3GR.** To register for 'FOLLOWING CHRIST' course, please send your full name, your e-mail address and preferably your mobile telephone number to **stbrigids@downandconnor.org**

EUCCHARISTIC ADORATION

Down and Connor Diocese is renewing and developing its **Diocesan Adoration Lay Committee** in order to increase the practice of Eucharistic Adoration in parishes throughout the diocese. You are welcome to attend an Information Meeting at **ONE** of these venues:
Thu 1st Oct The Parish Centre, Ballymena 2,Broughshane Rd **BT43 7DX 8PM**
Fri 2nd Oct St Patrick's Centre, Downpatrick Market St **BT30 6LZ 8PM**
Registration from 7.30pm. See poster in church for details.

St Malachy's College

St Malachy's College presents a concert **on Saturday 3rd October at 7pm** in the College Hall. Distinguished past pupils will perform (classical, traditional and jazz) to honour three former teachers
Frs Kevin and Brendan McMullan and Mrs Mary Mallon.

Admission is free, please register attendance by emailing:
alumni@stmalachyscollege.com

St Michael's Primary School



Temporary Classroom Assistant Vacancy (25 Hours per Week, 8:30-2pm with lunch break) Immediate Start
St Michael's Primary School is seeking to appoint a **Temporary Classroom Assistant (25 hours per week)**. We are looking for a caring, enthusiastic and committed individual who enjoys working with children and can make a positive contribution to our school community. **Interested applicants are asked to contact the school by email at info@stmichaels.belfast.ni.sch.uk**

PARISH NEWS & EVENTS

WEEKLY COLLECTION:

Holy Rosary: £1563.00

St. Bernadette's: £1418.87

AUTUMN VOLUNTARY COLLECTION:

Holy Rosary: £993.00

St. Bernadette's: £924.50

Many thanks for your continued generosity and support

The monthly offering for the Support of the Priests will be taken up next weekend after Communion. Collection offering can be made by standing order or the Dona machines in the church porch.

If you wish to contribute to the parish regularly and wish to receive a box of Offertory envelopes or standing order form, please contact the Holy Rosary parish office and leave your name and contact details with Kylee and Philomena will contact you or you can email Philomena directly at

p.dawson@downandconnor.org

stating which parish you wish to contribute to.

St Bernadette's Parish Centre

for all bookings and enquiries please email:
stbernadettes@downandconnor.org

Holy Rosary Senior Citizens

Senior Citizens monthly meet-up returns after summer break.
New members very welcome.

St Bernadette's Retirement Group

We hope to see you at our next coffee morning on **Wednesday 21st October** after Mass. New members are always welcome. £5 registration.

Our Thursday weekly walk: we meet at 10:15 in the church carpark.

All members are very welcome to join in at any time.



B.I.N.G.O is back, we're hoping for a FULL HOUSE!

18th October & 15th November.

REST IN PEACE

Recently Deceased:

Gerry McCoy
Deirdre Mullan
Mary (May) Burke
Yvonne Cowan
Daniel Carty
Fr. Michael McConville
Georgia Ann Nugent
Joesph Rollins
Michael McKinney
Philip Smith

Anniversaries:

Helen Rennick (6pm)
Colum McCavana (10.30am)
Vera O'Gorman (11am)
John Mc Elhatton (12.30pm)

Edward Gogarty, Jim Mc Donagh, Patrick Moss
Alex McAllister, Assumpta Meenan, Stephen Banks

Eternal rest grant unto them, O Lord

The Liturgy

Sunday Mass

Saturday: 6.00 pm (Vigil Mass)

Sunday: 9.30 am
12.00 noon

Weekday Mass Times

Monday: 7.00 pm
Tuesday: 9.30 am
Wednesday: 9.30 am
Thursday: 9.30 am
Friday: 7.00 pm
Saturday: 12 noon

Confession

Monday: 7.30 pm – 8.00 pm
Friday: 6.30 pm – 7.00 pm
Saturday: 12.30 pm – 1.00 pm &
5.30 pm – 6:00 pm

Eucharistic Adoration

Monday: 7.30 pm – 8.00 pm

Baptisms

1st & 3rd Sunday of the Month at 1.30pm
Please contact the Parish Office to book

Marriages

At least 6 months' notice required prior to date of Marriage.
Please contact Fr Sheehan

PARISH OFFERTORY COLLECTION

(Total includes Basket Collections, Standing Orders and Dona Donations)

Weekly Collection 20th Sept: £4762.50

Autumn Collection 20th Sept: £2355.50

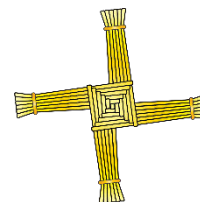
Medical Missionaries of Mary

The Medical Missionaries of Mary will be with us here at **St Brigid's Parish on the weekend of 3rd and 4th October 2026**. They will speak of their work, mainly in Africa and South America, and their mission to bring Christ's healing love to those most in need. Our parish and our diocese have supported MMM generously in the past, both in finance and in prayer, and MMM wishes to express gratitude for that support and to emphasise that we here at home are the body of mission, and those who are sent to far away places are the hands and the feet.

Help with Sunday Mass Screens

We need volunteers to operate the new screens that support singing and participation at each Sunday Mass. Simple system; training provided. Serve once every few weeks.

Send your **name, address, email, and age** to the parish office. Training sessions last about 30 minutes.



Saint Brigid's Parish

26th Sunday in O T
27th September 2026, Year A

Parish Priest: Fr Michael Sheehan **Tel:** 028 9066 5409

Parish Office: 028 9066 5409; (9 am - 1 pm Weekdays)

Address: 40 Derryvolgie Avenue, Belfast, BT9 6FP

Email: stbrigids@downandconnor.org **Website:** stbrigidsparishbelfast.org

Livestream/Webcam: youtube.com/@stbrigidsparishbelfast



26th Sunday in Ordinary Time

First Reading: Reading from the prophet Ezekiel Ezk 18:25-28
When the sinner renounces sin, he shall certainly live.

Responsorial Psalm: Ps 24:4-9
Remember your mercy Lord.

Second Reading: Reading from the St Paul to the Philippians Ph 2:1-11
In your minds you must be the same as Christ Jesus.

Gospel: According to Matthew Mt 21:28-32
He thought better of it and went. Tax collectors and prostitutes are making their way into the kingdom of God before you.

Anniversary List

Please pray for Mary Katrina McGrattan recently deceased, and for those whose anniversaries are at this time: Noel Boyle, Leo McGonigal, John Thomas, Joan Barbour-McMullen, Joe O'Neill, Maura McMullan, Dan Cullen, Rita O'Reilly, Osmunde Duffy, Ernesto Fuscuardi, Marie Allen, Theresa McCauley, Damien and Peter Berine, Angela McAllister, Ethna Wilson, Veronica Crangle, Liz and Harry Shevlin, John MacElhatton, Terry O'Kane, Nuala Dowds, Margaret Devlin, John Donaghy;

May they rest in peace

Mass Intentions for week ahead

Thurs 1st Oct 9.30am: *Special Intention*

Fri 2nd Oct 7pm: *John Donaghy (A)*

Sat 3rd Oct 6pm: *Patricia Boyle (MM)*

Dear Parishioners

Whilst reluctant to make new changes in my first year as Parish Priest, it has been suggested that in order to accommodate the possibility of Saturday morning funerals as well as accommodating weddings prior to 1.30/2.00pm that we should move the 12noon Mass on Saturday to 9.30am. (Cemetery's in the city close at 11.00am.) This would also provide the opportunity to have Baptism celebrated on a Saturday as well as a Sunday.

Baptisms on the 1st Sunday of the month at 1.30pm and the 3rd Saturday of the month at 11.00am.

This would entail moving Saturday morning confessions to 10.00am.

I would welcome hearing your views.

Fr Michael

GIFT – Growing in Faith Together

GIFT 5 programme (Year 12) will start back this **Sunday, 27th September**, from **6.30pm – 8.00pm in the Parish Hall**. The programme will run for 4 consecutive weeks finishing on Sunday 18th October. **PLEASE NOTE THE PROGRAMME IS FULL.**

Youth Faith Group

Our parish Youth Faith Group recommences again on **Sunday 4th October in the parish hall running from 6.30 - 8.00pm**. All our young people from year 12 and upwards (age 15 and over) are invited to come along and join in. Please note place preference will always be given to the young people who have attended the parish GIFT programme.

CHAPLET OF DIVINE MERCY

You are warmly invited to join us as we pray the chaplet of Divine Mercy in St Brigid's church every FRIDAY at 3pm. It's a beautiful way to start the weekend!

Jesus said to Sister Faustina: At 3 O'clock, implore my mercy especially for sinners.... This is the hour of great mercy for the whole world. In this hour I will refuse nothing to the soul that makes a request of me in virtue of my passion.



Food Bank Collection

St Brigid's support to the South Belfast foodbank makes a huge difference to the lives of people living in poverty. Non perishable food items can be donated after all Masses on the **3rd/4th October 2026**. The September collection weighed in at 354.95kgs.

Thank you for your support.

List of **items currently most needed**: Tinned fish; Tinned meat; Tinned vegetables; Tinned tomatoes; Rice; Rice pudding and Custard; Coffee; Tea; Cooking sauces; UHT milk; Jam/Honey/Spreads; Biscuits; Large sized nappies(5+); Detergent; Toilet roll; Toiletries



Parish Open Morning



Ever been curious about what goes on in your Parish?
This is your chance to find out.



Date: Sunday 11th October 2026

Venue: St Brigid's Parish Hall

Time: After both Masses

If you are the representative of a Parish Group and have not been notified about this already, please let the Parish Office know and we will get in touch with you.

Season of Creation 2026 (1 September – 4 October)

*St Brigid's Care for Our Common Home Group
invite you to join them in action.*



What action will we take in this season to show care for our planet, our common home?

Action an Eco - tip

- Endeavour to buy locally sourced food on one shopping visit
- Make one journey on foot or use public transport
- Select one day and turn off all non- essential lights

Start the conversation with family and friends – what can we do to care for our common home? Involve young people in our conversations – their voice matters - they will inherit the planet that we create.

For more ideas visit: <https://stbrigidsparishbelfast.org/events/season-of-creation>

Our Lady's Rosary Festival will take place from 12th to 18th October 2026.

Join us for a week of events to honour Our Blessed Lady, ending with the annual Belfast Rosary Procession. The procession will leave St Malachy's Church, Belfast City Centre, at 2.30pm on Sunday 18th October, and finish at St Peter's Cathedral. A full list of events can be found on the poster at the back of the Church and online at belfastrosaryfestival.com

Radio Maria is an Irish-run Catholic Talk-Radio Station where we can enjoy commercial free broadcasting – Prayer, Catechesis, Uplifting music, Talks, Interviews and Testimonies. Here's how you can listen:

Via Digital TV – Saorview Channel 210 or 826 on Freeview

Download our FREE App "RADIO MARIA IRELAND"

Streaming on our WEBSITE www.radiomaria.ie

Via our 'Listen Live Radio' link on our Facebook Page.

Via PHONE – get live radio feed by calling +353 (0) 1 437 3277

